

Yushi Sugimoto

Associate Professor
Graduate School of Frontier Biosciences
The University of Osaka

 [personal website](#)
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Research Computational Neurolinguistics
Interests Syntax, Creole Formation

Employment

2026-	Associate Professor (fixed term) Graduate School of Frontier Biosciences	The University of Osaka
2024-2026	Lecturer Division of Language and Culture, Graduate School of Humanities	The University of Osaka
2022-2024	Project Researcher Language and Information Sciences, Graduate School of Arts and Sciences	The University of Tokyo

Education

2018-2022	Ph.D. in Linguistics	University of Michigan, Ann Arbor
2016-2020	DOCTORAL PROGRAM [WITHDRAWN]	Sophia University
2014-2016	M.A. in Linguistics	Sophia University
2010-2014	B.A. in English and American Literature	Keio University

Education: Non-Degree

2017-2018 Visiting Student, University of Michigan, Department of Linguistics

Grants, honours & awards

2026-2029	Grants-in-Aid for Scientific Research, Grant-in-Aid for Transformative Research Areas (B), Japan Society for the Promotion of Science. Kei Kimura (PI)
2025-2028	JSPS Grant-in-Aid for Young Scientists (25K16284) A neuro-computational research on syntactic processing in the brain Yushi Sugimoto (PI) ¥4,680,000 (Direct Cost: ¥3,600,000, Indirect Cost: ¥1,080,000)
2024-2028	JSPS Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (S) (23H05493) Explorations into the Neurocognitive Basis of Symbolic Processing: Focusing on the Mediation System between Form and Meaning of Human Language Hiromu Sakai (PI)
2022-2026	JSPS Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (C) (22K00609) Theoretical and Demonstrative Research on Variation of Defectiveness of Sentence Structure and Locality of Movement

Nobu Goto (PI)

2022	Rackham Humanities Research Fellowship	University of Michigan
2021	John D'Arms Faculty Award Graduate RA	University of Michigan
2017-2018	Grant-in-Aid for JSPS Fellows (DC2, 17J03420)	
2017-2018	JSPS Overseas Challenge Program for Young Researchers (201780049)	

Publications & Talks

JOURNAL ARTICLES

- 2025 Alan Ke, Andrew McInerney, and Yushi Sugimoto. Lack of c-command in coordinate structures: Evidence from binding. *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory*, 2025, [All authors equally contributed to this work]. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11049-025-09662-8>.
- 2024 Yushi Sugimoto, Ryo Yoshida, Hyeonjeong Jeong, Masatoshi Koizumi, Jonathan R. Brennan, and Yohei Oseki. Localizing Syntactic Composition with Left-Corner Recurrent Neural Network Grammars. *Neurobiology of Language*, vol. 5, no. 1, pp. 201–224, Apr. 2024. doi: [10.1162/nol_a_00118](https://doi.org/10.1162/nol_a_00118).
- 2023 Yushi Sugimoto and Acrisio Pires. A parameter-free underspecification approach to complementizer agreement. *Revista Linguística*, vol. 18, no. 1, pp. 62–81, 2023. doi: <https://doi.org/10.31513/linguistica.2022.v18n1a56350>
- 2022 Yushi Sugimoto and Marlyse Baptista. A late-insertion-based exoskeletal approach to the hybrid nature of functional features in creole languages. *Languages*, vol. 7, no. 2, 2022, issn: 2226-471X. doi: [10.3390/languages7020092](https://doi.org/10.3390/languages7020092).
- 2021 Yushi Sugimoto. Labeling defective T. *Studia Linguistica*, vol. 75, no. 1, pp. 150–164, 2021. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1111/stul.12154>.

BOOKS

- 2023 Noam Chomsky, T. Daniel Seely, Robert C. Berwick, Sandiway Fong, M. A. C. Huybregts, Hisatsugu Kitahara, Andrew McInerney, and Yushi Sugimoto. *Merge and the Strong Minimalist Thesis (Elements in Generative Syntax)*. Cambridge University Press, 2023. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1017/9781009343244>

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

- 2025 Ryo Yoshida, Shinnosuke Isono, Kohei Kajikawa, Taiga Someya, Yushi Sugimoto, and Yohei Oseki. If attention serves as a cognitive model of human memory retrieval, what is the plausible memory representation? In *Proceedings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, Wanxiang Che, Joyce Nabende, Ekaterina Shutova, and Mohammad Taher Pilehvar, Eds., Vienna, Austria: Association for Computational Linguistics, Jul. 2025, pp. 9795–9812, isbn: 979-8-89176-251-0. url: <https://aclanthology.org/2025.acl-long.483/>.

Ryo Yoshida, Yushi Sugimoto, and Yohei Oseki. Investigating psychometric predictive power of syntactic attention. In *Proceedings of the 29th Conference on Computational Natural Language Learning*. Gemma Boleda and Michael Roth, Eds., Vienna, Austria: Association for Computational Linguistics, Jul. 2025,

pp. 407–418, isbn: 979-8-89176-271-8. url: <https://aclanthology.org/2025.conll-1.27/>.

- 2024** Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto, and Yushi Sugimoto. When the grammar doesn't mind which merge it chooses. In *Proceedings of the West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics* Robert Autry, Gabriela de la Cruz, Luis A. Irizarry Figueroa, Kristina Mihajlovic and Tianyi Ni and Ryan Smith, and Heidi Harley, Eds., 2024, pp. 61–70. url: <http://www.lingref.com/cpp/wccfl/39/abstract3617.html>.
- Taiga Someya, Yushi Sugimoto, and Yohei Oseki. JCoLA: Japanese corpus of linguistic acceptability. In *Proceedings of the 2024 Joint International Conference on Computational Linguistics, Language Resources and Evaluation (LREC-COLING 2024)*, Nicoletta Calzolari, Min-Yen Kan, Veronique Hoste, Alessandro Lenci, Sakriani Sakti, and Nianwen Xue, Eds., Torino, Italia: ELRA and ICCL, May 2024, pp. 9477–9488. url: <https://aclanthology.org/2024.lrec-main.828>
- 2022** Andrew McInnerney and Yushi Sugimoto. On dissociating adjunct island and subject island effects. In *Proceedings of the Linguistic Society of America*, vol. 7, May 2022, p. 5207. doi: 10.3765/plsa.v7i1.5207.
- Savithry Namboodiripad, Nicole Cuneo, Mathew A. Kramer, Yourdanis Sedarous, Felicia Bisnath, Yushi Sugimoto, and Adele Goldberg. Backgroundedness predicts island status of non-finite adjuncts in english. In *Proceedings of the 44th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 2022, pp. 1087–1093.
- 2021** Takanobu Nakamura and Yushi Sugimoto. Apparent de re construals of de se anaphor in Japanese. In *Proceedings of 28th Japanese/Korean Linguistics*. 2021.
- 2018** Yushi Sugimoto. Move-agree or agree-move? on the movement theory under free merge. In *Proceedings of 13th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics*. 2018.
- 2017** Yushi Sugimoto. Not so hyper: A-movement beyond clause boundaries? In *Proceedings of 12th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics*. pp. 273–280. 2017
- 2016** Yushi Sugimoto. De-phased by external pair-merge of C to T and its consequences. In *Proceedings of The Conference of the Student Organisation of Linguistics in Europe XXIV*, pp. 237–253. 2016.
- 2015** Yushi Sugimoto. Pair-merge as free merge. In *Proceedings of the 17th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar. Case and Agreement in Minimalism*. pp. 491–510. 2015

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026** Yushi Sugimoto, Ryo Yoshida, Masayuki Asahara, Hyeojeong Jeong, Akitake Kanno, Masatoshi Koizumi, and Yohei Oseki. 2026. BCCWJ-Brain: Brain Information Processing Benchmark for Language Model Evaluation. Annual Meeting of the Association for Natural Language Processing (NLP2026), Tochigi, Japan, March 12th, 2026. [poster]
- 2025** Itsuki Hamada, Yushi Sugimoto, Yohei Oseki, Michiru Makuuchi, and Hiromu Sakai. 2025. Neural correlates of prediction in language comprehension: An MEG study on Japanese classifier- noun processing. The International Symposium on Brain Function and Cognition (ISBFC): Neural Codes of Language and Action. Waseda University, Tokyo, Japan. September 9, 2025.
- Ryo Yoshida, Yushi Sugimoto, and Yohei Oseki. 2025. Investigating Psychometric Predictive Power of Syntactic Attention. The 29th Conference on Computational Natural Language Learning (CoNLL 2025). August 1st, 2025.

Shinnosuke Isono*, Kohei Kajikawa*, Yushi Sugimoto*, Masayuki Asahara, and Yohei Oseki. 2025. Exploring spatial and temporal dynamics of language comprehension in the brain with CCG. The 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci). Marriott Marquis, San Francisco, USA. July 31st, 2025 [*co-first authors] [poster]

Ryo Yoshida, Shinnosuke Isono, Kohei Kajikawa, Taiga Someya, Yushi Sugimoto, and Yohei Oseki. 2025. If Attention Serves as a Cognitive Model of Human Memory Retrieval, What is the Plausible Memory Representation? The 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL2025). July 30th, 2025.

Yushi Sugimoto. 2025. Modeling Syntactic Composition in the Brain with Computational Models. Sophia University Linguistic Society. July 19th, 2025. Tokyo, Japan. [invited]

Shinnosuke Isono*, Kohei Kajikawa*, Yushi Sugimoto*, Masayuki Asahara, and Yohei Oseki. 2025. Modeling Japanese EEG data with CCG. Annual Meeting of the Association for Natural Language Processing (NLP2025), Nagasaki, Japan, March 13th, 2025. [theme section] [*co-first authors]

Yushi Sugimoto, Ryo Yoshida, Hyeojeong Jeong, Akitake Kanno, Masatoshi Koizumi, and Yohei Oseki. 2025. BCCWJ-MEG: A novel Japanese MEG dataset. Annual Meeting of the Association for Natural Language Processing (NLP2025), Nagasaki, Japan, March 12th, 2025. [poster]

2024 Yushi Sugimoto, Ryo Yoshida, Hyeojeong Jeong, Akitake Kanno, Masatoshi Koizumi, and Yohei Oseki. 2024. Investigating Syntactic Attention in the brain. Society for the Neurobiology of Language 16th Annual Meeting, Brisbane, Australia, October 24-26, 2024. [poster]

Yushi Sugimoto. 2024. Boxing and Remnant Movement. SMOG & ANU International Conference on Syntax and Semantics (ICSS2024), Andong National University, Southern Korea, August 20, 2024. [online] [Invited]

Taiga Someya, Yushi Sugimoto, Yohei Oseki. 2024. JCoLA: Japanese Corpus of Linguistic Acceptability. LREC-Coling 2024. Lingotto Conference Centre, Torino, Italia, May 25-30, 2024.[poster]

2023 Acrisio Pires and Yushi Sugimoto. 2023. A Parameter-free Underspecification Approach to Complementizer Agreement. The 53rd Linguistic Symposium on Romance Languages [LSRL53], June 29th, Paris, France.

Yushi Sugimoto and Marlyse Baptista. 2023. A Novel Feature of the complementizer system in Cabo Verdean Creole. The 53rd Linguistic Symposium on Romance Languages [LSRL53], June 29th, Paris, France.

Yushi Sugimoto, Ryo Yoshida, Hyeojeong Jeong, Masatoshi Koizumi, Jonathan R. Brennan, and Yohei Oseki. 2023. Modeling Japanese fMRI data with left-corner Neural Network Grammar. Annual Meeting of the Association for Natural Language Processing (NLP2023), Okinawa, Japan, March 16th, 2023. [poster] [proceedings in Japanese]

2022 Savithry Namboodiripad, Felicia Bisnath, Nicole Cuneo, Matthew A. Kramer, Yourdanis Sedarous, Yushi Sugimoto, and Adele Goldberg. 2022. Backgroundedness predicts island status of non-finite adjuncts in English. The 44th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Metro Toronto Convention Centre, Toronto, Canada, July 30th, 2022.

Alan Ke, Andrew McInnerney, and Yushi Sugimoto. 2022. Lack of c-command in coordinate structures: Evidence from binding. 45th Generative Linguistics in the Old World [GLOW45], Queen Mary University of London, April 28th, 2022. [online oral presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution] [Acceptance rate 11% (24 out of 213)]

Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto and Yushi Sugimoto. 2022. Privileges of the Rich. The 46th Penn Linguistic Conference [PLC46], March 19th, 2022. [online poster presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]

Andrew McInnerney, and Sugimoto, Yushi. 2022. On dissociating adjunct island and subject island effects: syntactic vs. extrasyntactic approaches. The 96th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America [LSA2022], Washington D.C., January 6th, 2022 [online poster presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]

Yushi Sugimoto and Marlyse Baptista. 2022. On the nature of the hybrid grammar of creole formation: a case study of functional features. The 96th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America [LSA2022], Washington D.C., January 6th, 2022 [online poster presentation due to COVID-19]

2021 Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto and Yushi Sugimoto. 2021. Adding a locus of variation as underspecification. Workshop on Linguistic Variation at the Interfaces II, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, November 18th, 2021. [online oral presentation due to COVID-19]

Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto and Yushi Sugimoto. 2021. When the grammar doesn't mind which Merge it chooses. The 39th meeting of the West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics, [WCCFL39], hosted by The University of Arizona's Department of Linguistics, April 11th, 2021. [online oral presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]

Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto and Yushi Sugimoto. 2021. Options of Externally Merging {v, T, C} — a Comparative Approach. The 45th Penn Linguistic Conference [PLC45], March 20th, 2021. [online oral presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]

Andrew McInnerney, and Yushi Sugimoto. 2021. Subject Islands in a Simplest Merge System. The 95th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America [LSA2021], January 9th, 2021 [online poster presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]

Takanobu Nakamura, and Yushi Sugimoto. 2020. Where does the 'self' come from? A de se binding approach to zibun in Japanese. 28th Japanese/Korean Linguistics Conference [JK28], September 16th, 2020. [online poster presentation due to COVID-19, second author]

2020 Yushi Sugimoto. 2020. A dynamic process in forming structural backbone of creole languages. The 94th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America [LSA2020], New Orleans, January 3th, 2020. [poster]

2018 Takanobu Nakamura, and Yushi Sugimoto. 2018. Long distance relativisation and phasal transfer of KP. Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Association of Great Britain [LAGB]. University of Sheffield, UK. September 14th, 2018 [poster, second author].

2017 Yushi Sugimoto. 2017. Move-Agree or Agree-Move? On the movement theory under free Merge. The 13th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics [WAFL13]. International Christian University, Japan, May 27th, 2017. [poster]

2016 Yushi Sugimoto. 2016. Not so Hyper: A-movement Beyond Clause Boundaries? Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics 12 [WAFL12]. Central Connecticut State University, US, May 14th, 2016. [poster]

Yushi Sugimoto. 2016. De-Phasing Effect: External Pair-Merge of phase head and non-phase head. 39th Generative Linguistics in the Old World [GLOW39], Linguistics in Göttingen, Germany, April 6th, 2016. [poster], Abstract published in GLOW Newsletter #76, 176-178.

Yushi Sugimoto. 2016. De-Phased by External Pair-Merge of C to T and Its Consequences. The Conference of the Student Organisation of Linguistics in Europe [ConSOLE XXIV], The University of York and York St. John University, UK, January 8th, 2016.

2015 Yushi Sugimoto. 2015. Pair-Merge as Free Merge. The 17th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar [SICOGG17] at Kyung Hee University, Seoul, Korea, August 5th, 2015.

TALKS

2026 BCCWJ-MRI/MEG: Modeling Sentence Processing in the Brain with Language Models. Tohoku University, Sendai, Miyagi, Japan. March 23th, 2026. [Invited], [link](#)

Evaluating Language Models Using Brain Data. Kyushu University, March 6th, 2026. [Invited]

Modeling Syntactic Composition in the Brain with Syntactic Language Models. A seminar at United Graduate School of Child Development, The University of Osaka, February 5th, 2026. [Invited]

2025 MC framework (and beyond?). Neo-Grammar Circle (NGC). South Korea, December 6th, 2025. [online, Invited]

Modeling Syntactic Composition in the Brain with Small/Syntactic Language Models. Kyushu University Linguistic Society. September 25th, 2025, Kyushu University, Fukuoka, Japan. [Invited]

Modeling Syntactic Composition in the Brain with Computational Models. ISBFC Neural Codes Seminar 2025, September 3rd, 2025, Nagano, Japan.

Current Issues in Minimalism : GK, MC and beyond? Keio Linguistic Colloquium, Keio University, Tokyo, Japan, 05/10-11, 2025 [Invited]

2024 Merge of Functional Heads: A Theory of Amalgamation, JSPS Core-to-Core Program “International Research Network for the Human Language Faculty”, International Workshop 2024, Osaka University, Osaka, Japan, 12/07/2024

Modeling Syntactic Composition in the brain with Small/Syntactic Language Models, talk at Hiromu Sakai’s lab meeting, Waseda University, Japan, 11/05/2024

A Late-Insertion-Based Exoskeletal Approach to the Hybrid Nature of Functional Features in Creole Languages, Core-to-Core Program (member internal meeting/seminar), Osaka University, Osaka, Japan, 04/23/2024 [online]

2023 Modeling Japanese fMRI data with left-corner Neural Network Grammar, Setagaya Linguistic Circle, Tokyo, Japan, 06/03/2023

Recombination of Functional Features: A Late-Insertion-Based Exoskeletal Approach to Creoles (with Marlyse Baptista), Penn Syntax Lab meeting, Pennsylvania, US, 04/07/2023. [online]

A fresh view of SMT [Review of Chomsky's talks at KEIO-EMU lecture series] Keio study group on generative grammar, Tokyo, Japan, 03/22-23/2023 [online]

BCCWJ-MRI/MEG. AI Yotta International Symposium. Tohoku University, Sendai, 03/10/2023 [online]

Merge of Functional Heads: A Theory of Amalgamation (with Andreas Blümel and Nobu Goto), Tohoku University, Sendai, Japan, 02/12/2023 [Invited]

2022 A Late-Insertion-Based Exoskeletal Approach to the Hybrid Nature of Functional Features in Creole Languages, 10/01/2022 Keio Linguistic Colloquium, Tokyo, Japan [online] [Invited]

MISCELLANEOUS WORK

2022 Underspecification and (im)possible derivations: Toward a restrictive theory of grammar. Ph.D Thesis, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor. Committee: Acrisio Pires (co-chair), Marlyse Baptista (co-chair), Richard L. Lewis, Terje Lohndal

Teaching

2026-2025	A Door to Academia (Introduction to Neuroscience)	The University of Osaka
	Integrated Research on Theoretical Linguistics and Neurolinguistics	Kyushu University
	Summer Intensive Course, September 22th-26th, 2025	
2025-2026	Psycholinguistics	The University of Osaka
2024-	Integrated English	The University of Osaka
2023	Intermediate/Advanced Syntax	Keio University
	English communication I/II	Tokyo University of Agriculture
2017	Industrial English	Tokyo Polytechnic University

Advising

GRADUATE

2026	Shuki Otani	The University of Osaka	[committee member]
	dissertation title:		
	<i>Revisiting Tagalog Null Arguments with Agreement: its implications for Austronesian Syntax</i>		
	Jananeh Shalpour	Kyushu University	[committee member]
	dissertation title:		
	<i>Japanese Speakers' Second Language Sentence Processing: Behavioral, ERP, and MRI Evidence</i>		

Membership

Society for the Neurobiology of Language
The Association for Natural Language Processing

Skills

Python (Nilearn, MNE-Python, Eelbrain)

MATLAB

R

L^AT_EX